

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's time to meet someone important!



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you have short conversations with co-workers or classmates?
- What topics do you normally talk about?

Can Do Statements

- I can make small talk in the workplace.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can find out about someone's work background.

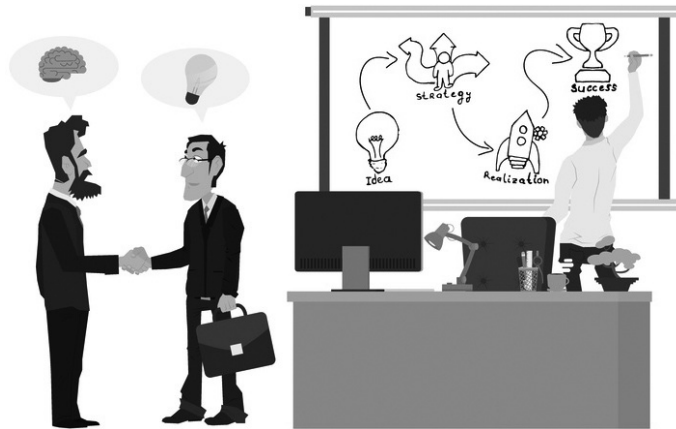




Let's Explore!

Ferdinand and Rocco meet. Does Ferdinand get the **yea or nay***?

* An affirmation of either *yes (yea)* or *no (nay)*.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Ferdinand:** Mr. Fontana - what a pleasure to meet you!
- Rocco:** Just Rocco is fine, Ferdinand. Young man, I've heard many good things about you. How have you been? I hear your parents are back in the homeland.
- Ferdinand:** You heard right. They're in Sao Paulo and I'm already lonesome!
- Rocco:** I sympathize. My daughter has recently moved to Milan. I miss her and my grandson dreadfully.
- Ferdinand:** How many children have you got?
- Rocco:** One daughter, one grandchild. And you?
- Ferdinand:** I have a niece who is like a daughter. She's been with me since her graduation. All our extended family is in Brazil.
- Rocco:** You were a public relations manager there, weren't you?
- Ferdinand:** I was. For a high-end condominium project in Rio de Janeiro.
- Rocco:** What were your areas of responsibility?
- Ferdinand:** Communications, publicity, promotion and press agency.
- Rocco:** Did you work with public relations?
- Ferdinand:** Not directly. I did however have some involvement with public affairs.
- Rocco:** Excellent. What kind of financial restrictions were you working within?
- Ferdinand:** Finance was not my area.
- Rocco:** Have you ever developed a budget plan?
- Ferdinand:** No. I'd propose an event, make a presentation and wait for the yea or nay. There was plenty of external funding.
- Rocco:** Something we don't have. Well, I see why we have been paired together. It will be my yea or nay from now on, Ferdinand!



Let's Practice!

Ferdinand tells Rocco about his previous job. What words does he use?

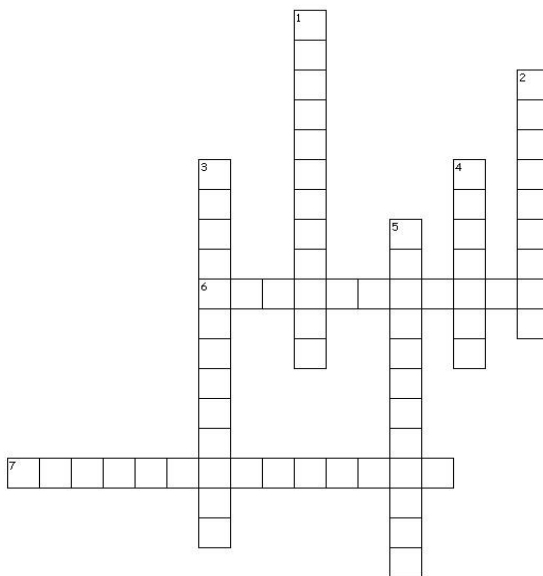
Instructions: Read the clues to complete the crossword. Practice reading the definitions to a partner and practice listening to your partner saying the definitions and guessing the corresponding word. Correct each other's pronunciation.

Across

6. It is the act of taking part in something.
7. It is the field of study concerned with the transmission of information by various means.

Down

1. They are things that decide or limit the way in which something can be done.
2. It is the business of attracting the attention of the public to something or somebody.
3. They are issues and questions about social, economic, political or business activities that affect the public.
4. Something that is expensive and of high quality.
5. It is a job in which you supply information and advertising material about a particular person or topic.



Let's Practice!

Talking about work background.

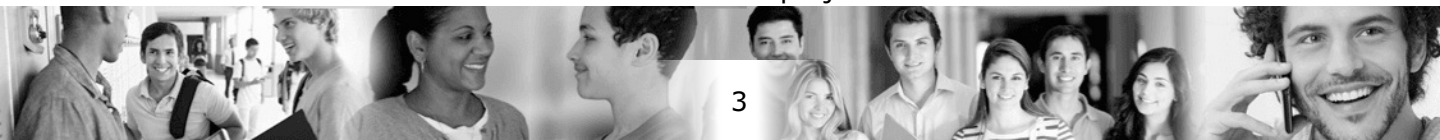
Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. Read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. You were a public relations manager there, weren't you?
2. What were your areas of responsibility?
3. Did you work with public relations?
4. What kind of financial restrictions were you working within?
5. Have you ever developed a budget plan?

COLUMN B

- a. Communications, publicity, promotions and press agency.
- b. No. I'd propose an event, make a presentation and wait for the yea or nay. There was plenty of external funding.
- c. Not directly. I did however have some involvement with public affairs.
- d. Finance was not my area.
- e. I was. For a high-end condominium project in Rio de Janeiro.





Extension Activity

Meeting new people.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a dialogue (10-12 lines) between you and a co-worker.
- Choose a proper greeting and make sure you ask and answer questions.
- Extend the dialogue by including one or two lines asking and answering questions about work experiences you've had or haven't had.
- Read the dialogue aloud with a partner and practice it together.
- When you are finished, try to have a similar conversation with another partner, but this time try not to use the dialogue.

Self-Assessment

Yes**No**

I meet and greet a co-worker.

☐☐

I ask and answer questions to find out about their work background.

☐☐

I have a conversation with a partner without a dialogue.

☐☐

Target Words

- **high-end** (adjective): expensive and of high quality
e.g. I worked for a high-end condominium project.
- **communications** (noun): the field of study concerned with the transmission of information by various means
e.g. I used to work in communications.
- **publicity** (noun): the business of attracting the attention of the public to something or somebody
e.g. I've also worked in publicity a few years ago.
- **press agency** (noun): supplying information and advertising material about a particular person or topic
e.g. I hear you work in press agency.
- **public affairs** (noun): issues and questions about social, economic, political or business activities that affect the public
e.g. Have you ever worked in public affairs?
- **involvement** (noun): the act of taking part in something
e.g. I've had a little involvement with the business.
- **restriction** (noun): things that decide or limit the way in which something can be done
e.g. What kind of financial restrictions were you working with?





Learning Points

Meeting People in the Workplace

In the workplace, you will need to deal with people on a daily basis. You will meet and greet co-workers frequently and at times you will develop relationships with them. Your relationships with your co-workers are the foundation of your working life.

Here are some expressions you can use to meet and greet co-workers as well as to ask and answer questions.

Saying Hello	Asking Someone How They Are	Responding
<i>Hi Mark!</i> <i>Hello Mark!</i> <i>Hey Mark!</i>	<i>How are you?</i> <i>How are things?</i> <i>How are you doing?</i> <i>How have you been?</i>	<i>Good, thanks!</i> <i>Not bad!</i> <i>Alright, thanks!</i> <i>All is well!</i> <i>I'm good!</i> <i>I'm OK!</i>

Returning the Question	Other Things You Can Say
<i>And you?</i> <i>You?</i> <i>How about you?</i> <i>What about you?</i>	<i>What a pleasure to (finally) meet you!</i> <i>It's good to see you again!</i> <i>It's been a long time, hasn't it?</i> <i>I have heard many things about you!</i>

NOTE: In some cultures, it is common to talk about your families in the workplace.





Learning Points

Finding Out about Someone's Work Background

When you meet and greet co-workers, you may also ask them about their previous experiences. When asking about their work experiences,

You can use the **Simple Past**, **Past Continuous** or **Present Perfect** tenses to ask questions.

	Simple Past	Past Continuous	Present Perfect
Form	<i>Did you ... ? Were you ... ?</i>	<i>Were + you + verb- ing</i>	<i>Have you ever + past participle ... ?</i>

Examples:

- *What were your areas of responsibility?*
- *Were you working from home?*
- *Have you ever developed a budget?*

